

ating system. The desktop environment, literally simulates a desk on the monitor of the computer, with folders, documents and applications like word processors. Desktop environments display the toolbars, icons, windows and animated effects in different ways. A desktop environment is a graphic interface that lets the user work with the operating system. Windows and OS X come with a single desktop environment, that can be themed, but not altered in the amount of resources they use, or the global options available for applications. For Linux however, a range of options are available. Most Linux distros offer users a choice between GNOME and KDE.

GNOME



GNOME (Gnu Network Object Model Environment), is one of the two most common desktop environments for Linux. It is a desktop environment for UNIX like operating systems, and works for GNU as well as Solaris. The GNOME Human Interface Guideline (HIG), is a set of rules that act as a benchmark for GNOME itself aims to achieve, and what competing desktop environments also consider. GNOME looks and feels like the Mac OS X, with the menu bar being along the top edge of the screen. There are a bunch of programs that come with GNOME, most notably, Nautilus, a small and swift file browser. GNOME is also bundled with f-spot, one of the most used photo management software for Linux. Gnome comes with Brasero, which is not as good a burning software as